

PHRYNOBATRACHIDAE

This family of small, terrestrial or semi-aquatic frogs is confined to sub-Saharan Africa. Most breed throughout the year, laying their eggs in water. They reach maturity in five months.

GOLDEN PUDDLE FROG

Phrynobatrachus auritus

This frog is so named because it breeds in very small pools. A ground-dwelling species, it is found in C. African rainforests.



ORNATE FROGS AND GRASS FROGS

Found in open country in Africa, Madagascar, and the Seychelles, the Ptychadenidae include many brightly coloured frogs. A streamlined body and strong hind legs make them prodigious jumpers.

MASCARENE RIDGED FROG

Ptychadena mascareniensis

Common on agricultural land, this frog has long legs and a pointed snout. It breeds in puddles, wheel ruts, and ditches.

4.5–7 cm
1¾–2¾ in



AFRO-ASIAN TREEFROGS

The Rhacophoridae range across Africa and much of Asia, and are mostly arboreal frogs. The family also includes flying frogs that glide from one tree to another. Many lay their eggs in foam nests, where the eggs and tadpoles stay protected against predators.



AFRICAN FOAM-NEST TREEFROG

Chiromantis rufescens

Found in the forests of W. and C. Africa, this frog lays its eggs in a foam nest attached to a branch overhanging water.

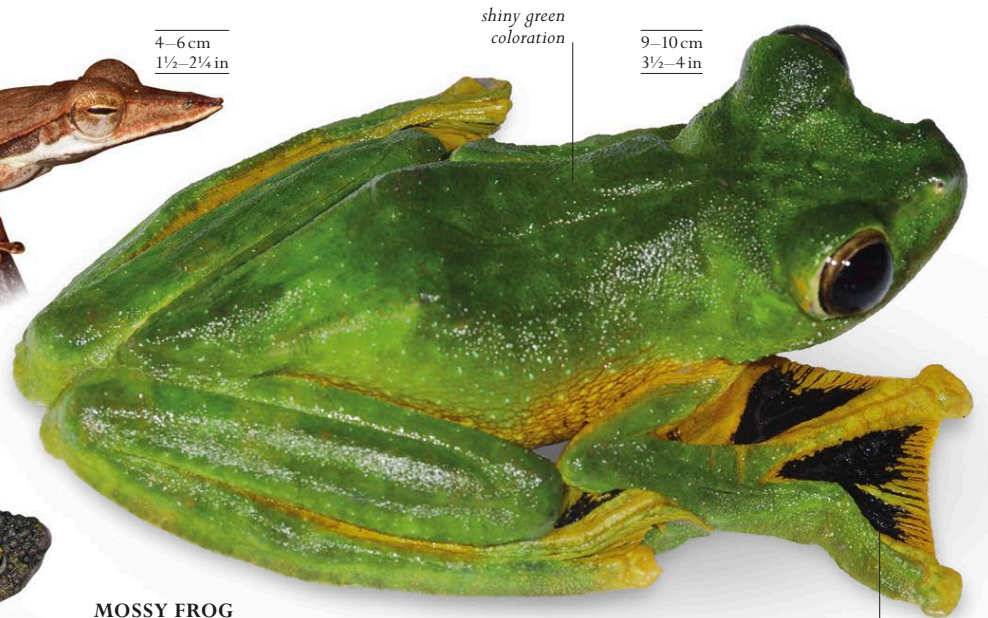
7–9 cm
2¾–3½ in



SOUTHERN WHIPPING FROG

Taruga longinasus

Endangered by the loss of much of its habitat, this arboreal frog occurs in Sri Lanka's remaining patches of rainforest.



MOSSY FROG

Theloderma corticale

The warty skin and green colour of this Vietnamese frog camouflages it against moss. It curls into a ball when threatened.

WALLACE'S FLYING FROG

Rhacophorus nigropalmatus

This arboreal species from the rainforests of S.E. Asia has webbed feet that enable it to glide between trees.

long, fully webbed fore- and hind feet

PYXICEPHALIDAE

Inhabiting a variety of habitats in sub-Saharan Africa, members of this family range in size from huge bullfrogs to typical pond frogs and tiny moss frogs. Most lay eggs in water, although some small species lay eggs on land.

AFRICAN BULLFROG

Pyxicephalus adspersus

Males of this large African species aggressively defend their eggs and tadpoles. They dig channels in soil to help the tadpoles reach open water.

powerful limbs

olive-green body with dark markings

8–23 cm
3¼–9 in

very wide mouth

